

IK 560: Vaiṣṇavism: History, Teachings and Practice

Course Code : IK 560

Course Name : Vaiṣṇavism: History, Teachings and Practice

L-T-P-C : 3-0-0-3

Intended for : BTech/MTech/MS/MSc/MA/Ph.D

Prerequisite : None

Mutual Exclusion: None

Approval: 42nd Senate

Course Contents

- **Introduction to Vaishnavism:** Historical evolution; Core beliefs and practices; Overview of key scriptures and teachers. (6 Hours)
- **Vaishnavism in the Vedic and Upanishadic Period:** Vedic references to Viṣṇu; Concepts of Nārāyaṇa in Upaniṣads in Upanishads; Early beginnings and foundations. (6 Hours)
- **The Epics and Puranic Vaishnavism:** Rāmāyaṇa and Mahabharata's influence; Stories of Vishnu's avatars; Puranic traditions and stories. (8 Hours)
- **Philosophical Foundations:** The Vedānta traditions of Rāmānuja, Madhva, and others; Concept of Bhakti (devotion); Viśiṣṭādvaita, Dvaita, and other schools of thought. (7 Hours)
- **Vaiṣṇava Practices, Rituals, and Festivals:** Daily rituals, temple worship, and pilgrimages; Festivals like Janmāṣṭamī, Rāma Navamī, and others; Role of music, dance, and art in Vaiṣṇavism. (7 Hours)
- **Modern Movements and Global Presence:** Gauḍīya Vaiṣṇavism and ISKCON; The spread of Vaiṣṇavism outside India; Contemporary challenges and contributions. (8 Hours)

Laboratory/practical/tutorial Modules:

- NA

Textbooks :

1. Bhatia, V., **Unforgetting Chaitanya: Vaishnavism and cultures of devotion in colonial Bengal**, Oxford University Press, 2017.
2. Flood, G., **An Introduction to Hinduism**, Cambridge University Press, 2004.

References :

1. Rocher, L., **The Puranas**, Otto Harrassowitz Verlag, 1986.
2. Thapar, R., **Chandragupta II and the Rise of Vaishnavism. Religion and World Civilizations** [3 volumes]: How Faith Shaped Societies from Antiquity to the Present [3 volumes], 68, 2023.